Tharifith

Riffian Language Course

LESSON 10

Possessives & Demonstratives

A Comprehensive Guide for Beginners Created by LEARN THARIFITH

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1. Introduction to Possession in Tharifith

Possession and demonstration are fundamental concepts in any language, allowing speakers to express relationships of ownership and to point out specific objects or people in their environment. In Tharifith, these concepts are expressed through a sophisticated system of suffixes and particles that attach to nouns or stand independently. Unlike English, which uses separate words like 'my,' 'your,' 'this,' and 'that,' Tharifith primarily uses suffixes that are attached directly to nouns, creating a more compact and integrated grammatical structure.

The possessive system in Tharifith is particularly elegant, with a set of suffixes that indicate the person, gender, and number of the possessor. These suffixes attach to the noun being possessed, creating a single word that expresses what would require two separate words in English. For example, 'akham' (room) becomes 'akham-inu' (my room) or 'akham-inek' (your room, masc), with the possessor information encoded in the suffix. This system is consistent and regular, making it relatively straightforward to learn once the basic patterns are understood.

Demonstratives in Tharifith also show interesting features, with distinctions based not only on number and gender but also on proximity, the distance between the speaker, the listener, and the object being referred to. Tharifith distinguishes between objects that are near the speaker, near the listener, and far from both, a three-way distinction that provides greater precision than the two-way distinction found in English. This lesson will guide you through both the possessive and demonstrative systems, providing you with the tools to express ownership and to point out objects with precision and clarity.

2. Possessive Suffixes

Possessive suffixes are the primary means of expressing possession in Tharifith. These suffixes attach directly to the noun being possessed, indicating who the possessor is. The suffixes vary based on the person, number, and in some cases, the gender of the possessor. Learning these suffixes is essential for expressing basic ownership relationships and for understanding how Tharifith encodes grammatical relationships within words rather than through separate words or particles.

2.1 Singular Possessive Suffixes

The singular possessive suffixes indicate that the possessor is a single person. Note that there are different forms for masculine and feminine possessors in the second person singular (your).

Person	Suffix	Example with Thadarth (house)	English
1st singular (my)	-inu	Thadarth-inu	my house
2nd singular masc (your)	-inek / -nech	Thadarth-inek	your house (to a man)
2nd singular fem (your)	-inem / -nnem	Thadarth-inem	your house (to a woman)
3rd singular masc & fem (his & her)	-ines / -nnes	Thadarth-ines	his house

2.2 Plural Possessive Suffixes

The plural possessive suffixes indicate that the possessor is multiple people. These suffixes are used when talking about something belonging to 'us,' 'you (plural),' or 'them.'

Person	Suffix	Example with akham (Room)	English
1st plural (our)	-nnegh	akham-nnegh	our room
2nd plural masc (your)	-nkum / -nwem	akham-nkum	your room (to men)
2nd plural fem (your)	-nkent / -nwent	akham-nkent	your room (to women)
3rd plural masc (their)	-nsen	akham-nsen	their room (men)
3rd plural fem (their)	-nsent	akham-nsent	their room (women)

2.3 Complete Paradigm with Examples (for family members only)

English	Tharifith
My father	Baba
Your father (masc)	baba-k / baba-ch
Your father (fem)	baba-m
His/her father	Baba-s
Our father	baba-thnagh

Your father (mas. pl)	baba- thkum / baba-thwem
Your father (fem. pl)	Baba-thkent / baba-thwent
Their father (mas. pl)	baba-thsen
Their father (fem. pl)	baba-thsent

3. Possessive Suffixes with Different Noun Types

The way possessive suffixes attach to nouns can vary depending on the gender of the noun and whether it is singular or plural. Masculine nouns beginning with a vowel may undergo slight modifications when suffixes are added, and feminine nouns typically lose their final '-th' before certain suffixes. Additionally, plural nouns follow specific patterns when combined with possessive suffixes. Understanding these variations is essential for using possessives correctly in all contexts.

3.1 Possessives with Masculine Nouns

Noun	With Suffix	English
Ahamuch (boy)	Ahamuch-inu	my boy (son)
Ahamuch	Ahamuch-inek	your boy
Ahamuch	Ahamuch-ines /-nnes	his/her boy
Aghrum (bread)	Aghrum-inu	my bread
Aghrum	Aghrum-nnegh	our bread
Amghar (old man)	Amghar-ines /-nnes	her father-in-law

3.2 Possessives with Feminine Nouns

Feminine nouns in Tharifith typically end in '-th' in their citation form. When possessive suffixes beginning with a consonant are added, the final '-th' may be retained or dropped depending on the specific noun and suffix. This variation requires attention and practice.

Noun	With Suffix	English
thahamuchth (girl)	thahamuchth-inu	my girl (daughter)
thahamuchth	thahamuchth-inek /-nech	your girl (daughter)
thahamuchth	thahamuchth-ines / -nnes	his/her girl(daughter)
thamgharth (woman)	Thamgharth-inu	my wife
thamgharth	thamgharth-ines / -nnes	his wife
thachejarth (tree)	thachejarth-nnegh	our tree

3.3 Possessives with Plural Nouns

Noun (Singular)	Plural	With Possessive	English
akham (room)	ikhamn	ikhamn-nnegh	our rooms
thahamuchth (girl)	Thihamuchin	thihamuchin-ines /-nnes	his/her daughters
aghzar (river)	Ighzran	ighzran-nsen	their rivers (mas.pl)
thafunasth (cow)	thifunasin	thifunasin-nkum /-nwem	your cows
thasrith (bride)	thisrathin	thisrathin-nsen	their wives
Argaz / aryaz	Irgazen / Iryazen	Irgazen/ iryazen-nsent	their husband

4. Independent Possessive Pronouns

While possessive suffixes are used when the possessed noun is mentioned, Tharifith also has independent possessive pronouns that can stand alone. These are used when the possessed noun is understood from context or has been mentioned previously. For example, in response to 'Which house is yours?' one might say 'This one is mine' using an independent possessive pronoun. These pronouns are also used for emphasis or contrast, as in 'My house is big, YOURS is small.'

4.1 Independent Possessive Forms

	Near to the speaker			Far from the speaker		
Person	**Masc. Form**	**Fem Form**	**English**	**Masc. Form**	**Fem. Form**	**English**
1st singular	wa-inu	tha-inu	This is mine	win-inu	thin-inu	That is mine
2nd singular masc	wa-inek / -nech	tha-inek/ -nech	This is yours (to a man)	win-inek/ -nech	thin-inek/ -nech	That is yours (to a man)
2nd singular fem	wa-inem	tha-inem	This is yours (to a woman)	win-inem	thin-inem	That is yours (to a woman)
3rd singular masc	wa-ines /-nnes	tha-ines /-nnes	This is his	win-ines /-nnes	thin-ines /-nnes	That is his
3rd singular fem	wa-ines / nnes	tha-ines / -nnes	This is hers	win-ines /-nnes	thin-ines / -nnes	That is hers
1st plural	wa-nnegh	tha-nnegh	This is ours	win-nnegh	thin-nnegh	That is ours
2nd plural masc	wa-nkoum/ -nwem	tha-nkoum/ -nwen	This is yours (plural masc)	win-nkoum/ -nwem	thin-nkoum/ -nwen	That is yours (plural masc)
2nd plural fem	wa-nkent/ -nwent	tha-nkent/ -nwent	This is yours (plural fem)	win-nkent/ -nwent	thin-nkent/ -nwent	That is yours (plural fem)
3rd plural masc	wa-nsen	tha-nsen	This is theirs (masc)	win-nsen	thin-nsen	That is theirs (masc)
3rd plural fem	wa-nsent	tha-nsent	This is theirs (fem)	win-nsent	thin-nsent	That is theirs (fem)

5. Demonstrative Adjectives

Demonstrative adjectives are used to point out specific nouns, indicating their location relative to the speaker and listener. In English, these are words like 'this,' 'that,' 'these,' and 'those.' Tharifith has a rich demonstrative system that distinguishes not only between singular and plural, masculine and feminine, but also between different degrees of proximity. The demonstrative particles are typically attached to the noun or appear immediately after it.

5.1 Basic Demonstrative Forms

Proximity	Masc. Singular	Fem. Singular	English
Near speaker	-a / wa / wanita	-a/ tha / thanita	this
Near listener	-nni / wenni	-nni / Thenni	that (near you)
Far from both	-in / win / win qayth	-in / thin / thin qayt	that (over there)

5.2 Demonstratives with Nouns

When demonstratives are used with nouns, they typically appear as particles following the noun.

Tharifith	English
Thadarth-a (tha)	this house (near me)
Thadarth-nni (thenni)	that house (near you)
Thadarth-in (thin)	that house (far away)
Abridh-a (wa)	this road (near me)
Abridh-nni (wenni)	that road (near you)
Abridh-in (win)	that road (far away)

5.3 Plural Demonstratives

Proximity	Masc. Plural	Fem. Plural	English
Near speaker	Ina	Thina	these
Near listener	Inni	Thinni	those (near you)
Far from both	Inin	Thinini	those (over there)

6. Proximity Degrees in Demonstratives

One of the most distinctive features of Tharifith demonstratives is the system of proximity distinctions. While English has only two degrees (near: this/these; far: that/those), Tharifith typically distinguishes three or even four degrees of distance. This allows speakers to be more precise about the spatial relationship between objects and the participants in a conversation. Understanding these distinctions is crucial for accurate communication and for understanding the spatial references that Riffian speakers make in everyday conversation.

6.1 Temporal Uses of Demonstratives

Demonstratives in Tharifith can also refer to time, distinguishing between present, recent past, and distant past events.

Tharifith	English
Nhar-a / ass-a (wa)	this day / today
Nhar-nni / ass-nni (wenni/thenni)	that day
asegg^{u}as-a (wa)	this year
asegg^{u}as-nni (wenni)	that year

7. Combining Possessives and Demonstratives

In Tharifith, it is common to combine possessive suffixes with demonstratives to create expressions like 'this house of mine' or 'that son of yours.' The order of elements and the way they combine depends on the specific construction being used. Understanding these combinations allows for more precise and nuanced expressions of possession and location.

7.1 Noun + Demonstrative + Possessive

Tharifith	English
Akham-a dh’akham-inu	this room is my room
Ahamuch-a inek/-nech ?	that boy is yours? (masc)
Thahamuchth-a inu	this girl is mine (my daughter)

7.2 Alternative Construction: Demonstrative + dh + Noun-Possessive

Tharifith	English
Wa dh'akham-inu	this is my room (near to the speaker)
win dh'akham-inek	that is your room (far from both)
tha dh yedji	this is my daughter
thin dh thasrith-ines / -nnes	that is his wife

8. Special Constructions

This section presents special constructions involving possessives and demonstratives that are common in Tharifith but may not follow the standard patterns presented earlier. These include expressions for parts of the body, kinship terms with special behaviors, and idiomatic expressions using possessive and demonstrative forms.

8.1 Body Parts with Possessives

Body parts in Tharifith typically require possessive suffixes, as they are inherently possessed. The possessor is almost always specified, unlike in English where 'the hand' can be used generically.

Tharifith	English
fudh-inu	my knee
ḍar-inu	my foot
fus-ines / -nnes	his/her hand
thighmesth-ines / -nnes	his/her tooth
thmijja-nnegh	our necks
ur-ines / -nnes	his/her heart

8.2 Idiomatic Expressions

Tharifith	English
s ufus-ines /-nnes	by his hand (he did it)
gi/dhi thittawin-ines / -nnes	in his eyes (his opinion)
itkhs-it s ur-ines /-nnes	he loves her with his heart
wa dh isem-ines / -nnes	this is his/her name
Gi/ dhi rḥar-ino	in my condition (as is)
Argaz-a ur-ghares-cha ur	this man has no heart (no feeling)

9. Practice Exercises

The following exercises will help you practice possessive suffixes, demonstratives, and their combinations. Work through each exercise carefully, referring back to the tables and examples as needed.

Exercise 1: Possessive Suffixes

Add the correct possessive suffix to each noun.

1. sawar (my pants) = sawar_____
2. baba (your father, to a woman) = baba_____
3. thahamuchth (his daughter) = thahamuchth_____
4. thasrith (our wife) = tislit_____
5. dchar (their tribe, masc) = dchar_____

Exercise 2: Demonstratives

Provide the correct demonstrative for each situation.

1. this television (near me) = television- _____
2. that village (far away) = dchar- _____
4. this boy (near me) = ahamuch- _____

5. that girl (far away) = thahamuchth- _____

Exercise 3: Independent Possessives

Translate the following into Tharifith using independent possessive pronouns.

1. This one is mine (masculine). _____
2. That one is yours (feminine, to a man). _____
3. This one is his (feminine). _____
4. Those are ours (masculine plural). _____
5. Those are theirs (feminine plural). _____

Exercise 4: Translation

Translate the following sentences into Tharifith.

1. This is my car. _____
2. is that your son ? (to a man). _____
3. This girl is my daughter. _____
4. Where is your brother? (to a fem) _____
5. That village (far) is ours. _____

Exercise 5: Complete the Sentences

Fill in the blanks with the correct possessive or demonstrative.

1. wa dh'abridh-_____ (This is my path)
2. win _____ (That one is yours, to a man)
3. thahamuchth- _____ dh thahamuchth-inu (This girl is my daughter)
4. mani yedja baba-_____? (Where is your father, to a woman?)
5. tha dh thasrith-_____ (That is his wife)

10. Answer Key

Exercise 1: Possessive Suffixes

Exercise 2: Demonstratives

Exercise 3: Independent Possessives

Exercise 4: Translation

Exercise 5: Complete the Sentences

11. Lesson Summary

In this lesson, you have mastered two essential grammatical systems in Tharifith: possessives and demonstratives. The possessive system uses suffixes that attach directly to nouns to indicate the possessor. The singular suffixes are -inu (my), -inek (your, masc), -inem (your fem), and -ines (his/her). The plural suffixes are -nnegh (our), -nkoum (your,masc pl), -nkent (your, fem pl) and -nsen/-nsent (their). These suffixes are consistent and regular, making them relatively straightforward to learn and use.

The demonstrative system in Tharifith is particularly rich, with a three or four-way distinction in proximity: wa / tha (near speaker), wenni /thenni (near listener), win /thin (far from both),

and ina /thina (pl; near speaker), inni /thinni (pl. near listener), inin / thinin (pl. far from both). This system allows for precise spatial reference that goes beyond the simple this/that distinction of English. Demonstratives agree with nouns in gender and number, and can function as both adjectives (modifying nouns) and pronouns (standing alone).

You have also learned independent possessive pronouns (win-inu, thin-inu, etc.) that can stand alone when the noun is understood from context. These are particularly useful for emphasis, contrast, and in responses to questions. The combination of possessives and demonstratives allows for expressions like 'this house of mine' and 'that son of yours.' Finally, you have seen how body parts and kinship terms behave with possessives, and learned some idiomatic expressions that use these grammatical forms.

Key forms to remember: -inu (my), -inek (your, masc), -ines (his/her), -nnegh (our), -nsen (their masc); -nsent (their fem); wa (this, masc), tha (this, fem), thenni (that near you), thin (that far away).